

Meoncross School History Department

YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of Meoncross pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized 3-tier scaffolding (Bronze sentence starters, Silver connectives, Gold historiographical analysis), consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 How much progress did the Romans make in public health?	• Describe the key features of Roman public health infrastructure, including aqueducts, bathhouses, and sewers • Explain how the Roman Empire's centralised power enabled large-scale public health projects • Evaluate the significance of Roman public health by assessing whether it represented genuine medical understanding or imperial prestige	• Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Change & Continuity): How much progress did the Romans make in public health? • Evaluating Primary Evidence
Lesson 2 Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?	• Explain how the collapse of Roman imperial power led to the decline of organised public health systems • Describe the role of the medieval Church in shaping attitudes to disease and sanitation • Assess the significance of the Black Death (1348) as a turning point in medieval public health	• Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Causation): Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?	- Describe the public health challenges caused by rapid urbanisation in Early Modern towns - Explain why governments failed to act despite growing evidence of poor sanitation - Evaluate the extent to which continuity, rather than change, defined public health between 1500 and 1750	Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Significance): To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?
Lesson 4 How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?	- Explain how industrialisation and mass migration to cities created unprecedented public health crises - Describe the role of key individuals (John Snow, Edwin Chadwick) in challenging existing beliefs about disease - Analyse the significance of the 1848 Public Health Act as an example of government intervention driven by causation evidence	Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Causation): How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?
Lesson 5 Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?	- Explain why it took Parliament so long to act on public health reform despite mounting evidence - Describe how the 'Great Stink' of 1858 became a turning point that forced government action - Evaluate the significance of Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system as a landmark of change in public health	Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Significance): Evaluate the impact of Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system on London.
Lesson 6 End of Unit Assessment: Cholera Investigation	- Evaluate how Dr John Snow used map data and scientific deduction to prove cholera was waterborne in 1854. - Explain the shift from laissez-faire government attitudes to compulsory state intervention in British public health. - Produce a structured 8-mark explanation assessing the significance of Victorian sanitation reforms.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Unit Key Vocabulary: Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-Faire • Cesspit • Back-to-back housing • Public Health Act 1848 • Public Health Act 1875 • Broad Street Pump • The Great Stink • Sewage System • Edwin Chadwick • John Snow • Joseph Bazalgette • Industrial Revolution

KS3: Medieval England & The Struggle for Power (1066–1485)

Year 7 | How did power shift in Medieval England?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?	- Describe the three rival claims to the English throne in 1066 and assess which was strongest - Explain how the Battle of Hastings demonstrated the role of power, luck, and military strategy in shaping history - Evaluate the significance of the Norman Conquest as a turning point in English history	- Knowledge Recall Quiz - PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): The Claimants' Pitch (Group Battle) - PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): The Turning Point Debate (Evaluation) - Evaluating Primary Evidence

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 2 Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?	- Explain how William used castles, the feudal system, and terror as tools of power and control - Describe how the Domesday Book functioned as a mechanism of royal authority and resistance suppression - Assess the effectiveness of William's methods in crushing Anglo-Saxon resistance	- Comprehension Activity - PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why William carried out the Harrying of the North and what the consequences were for the people living in the region. - PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Review the timeline of William's consolidation of power. Which method (Castles, Terror, or the Domesday Book) do you think was the most effective i... - Interrogating Historical Sources - Structured Paragraph
Lesson 3 Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?	- Explain why the relationship between the monarchy and the Church was a fundamental struggle for power in medieval England - Describe how the murder of Thomas Becket (1170) demonstrated the tension between feudal loyalty and religious authority - Evaluate the significance of the Becket affair for the balance of power between Church and Crown	- Core Knowledge Check - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain the main reasons why the relationship between King Henry II and Archbishop Thomas Becket broke down completely between 1162 and 1164. - Creative Task: Eyewitness Report. Look closely at the manuscript illumination of Becket's murder. Imagine you are a terrified monk hiding behind the pillars of Ca... - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 4 Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?	- Describe the key grievances that led the barons to challenge King John's power - Explain the significance of Magna Carta as a challenge to absolute monarchy and a step towards parliamentary democracy - Evaluate contrasting historical interpretations of Magna Carta: triumph of liberty or selfish baronial power grab?	- Recall Quiz (5 questions) - Historical Interpretations: Historical Interpretations: The Magna Carta - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): The Trial of King John (Interpretation)
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?	- Describe the key features of daily life for the peasantry in a medieval village - Explain how the feudal system and the Church controlled virtually every aspect of a peasant's existence - Assess the extent to which medieval peasants had any real power or agency within the feudal hierarchy	- Knowledge Recall Quiz - PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Describe what a tithe was, how it was collected, and why it caused tension between ordinary medieval peasants and the Church. - Creative Task: Design your own modern Doom Painting. Medieval Doom Paintings used demons and hellfire to scare peasants into behaving. If you were painting a 'Doo... - Evaluating Primary Evidence - Extended Writing (PEEL)
Lesson 6 Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?	- Describe the causes and spread of the Black Death across medieval England - Explain how the plague shattered the feudal system by empowering the peasantry through labour shortages - Evaluate the significance of the Black Death as a catalyst for change in medieval social order	- Comprehension Activity - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain how the Black Death transformed the balance of economic power between lords and peasants after 1348. - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): The Plague Doctor's Diary (Empathetic Writing)
Lesson 7 Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?	- Explain the causes of the Peasants' Revolt, linking them to the decline of feudalism and growing resistance to royal power - Describe the key events of the revolt and the role of leaders like Wat Tyler - Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt was a failure or a significant step towards challenging the power of the monarchy and Parliament	- Core Knowledge Check - Creative Task: Speechwriting. You are the radical priest John Ball. Write a short, rousing speech to deliver to the peasant army before they march on London. Make... - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): How much of a threat did the rebels actually pose to King Richard II and royal government when they seized London in June 1381?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 8 Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?	- Describe the causes of the Wars of the Roses and how rival claims to the monarchy led to civil war - Explain how propaganda and political manipulation shaped the conflict between York and Lancaster - Evaluate the significance of Henry VII's victory at Bosworth as the end of the medieval era and the birth of Tudor power	Recall Quiz (6 questions)
Lesson 9 Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?	- Synthesise knowledge of power, monarchy, feudalism, and the Church across the medieval period - Construct a sustained argument evaluating how far a medieval monarch's power was limited by resistance from barons, the Church, and the peasantry - Deploy specific historical evidence to support a judgement about the nature of medieval power	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Which of the two interpretations do you find more convincing? Explain your answer using your own knowledge. - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain why royal power weakened between 1066 and 1485 (12 marks) - Extended Writing (PEEL)
Unit Key Vocabulary: Power • Claim • Conquest • Anglo-Saxon • Significance • Feudal system • Resistance • Propaganda • Domesday Book • Motte-and-bailey • Church • Monarchy • Martyr • Excommunication • Canon law • Magna Carta • Democracy • Parliament • Interpretation • Baron • Peasantry • Tithe • Feudalism • Serf • Strip farming • Black Death • Change • Labour shortage • Statute of Labourers • Social order • Revolt • Poll tax • Wat Tyler • Villeinage • Dynasty • Usurper • Synthesis • Evidence • Judgement		